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kits.—Rajesh Suresh Joshi, manager-business development, Dynalog

growth of degree/diploma educational institutes in the technical field with the number of institutes increasing from 1600-plus a decade ago to 3000-plus now. This implies a very huge market for educational kits in India. It consists of all the modules required for setting up a standard laboratory as per the norms prescribed by the concerned authority. The total market includes sectors right from primary education to higher and technical education,” informs Rajesh Suresh Joshi, manager-business development, Dynalog.

Explaining the market size of robotic kits, which is a sub-sector within the educational kits industry, Adwait Deshpande, R&D head, robotics division, Thinklabs, says, “There are 5000-plus engineering colleges and, on an



“High-performance, low-power-consuming and eco-friendly products are in demand. Most of the MNCs are promoting their products in universities through university programmes, while enabling finishing schools to cater to the industry need by providing industry-ready trained candidates as part of their business strategy.—G.V. Gurunatham, chairman and managing director, Embedded Systems Solutions

average, there are 1000 students in each college (taking into account all branches and all years). This means there are a total of five million students. Sixty per cent of them, i.e., three million, are from mechanical, electrical and computer science streams. If we take 10 per cent (which is a very modest number) of that and assume that, on an average, they spend Rs 1000 a year on robotic kits, then the market is worth Rs 300 million.”

“All these markets have been growing at double the rate five years ago and are projected to keep growing at a medium to high rate,” says Sai Venkat Kumar, on behalf of Asia-Pacific marketing group, Tektronix India.

While education sector is the

“The hobby kits industry is, in general, price-sensitive, which is another challenge to overcome.—Adwait Deshpande, R&D head, robotics division, Thinklabs

driver of the educational and hobby kits market, other components of the demand-supply chain are the government, training providers, hardware supply companies and raw material suppliers. The market can be defined as a combination of test & measurement and training kits segments.

What's in demand?

Training solutions that completely cover a particular topic of interest are in demand. Presently, training systems for cutting-edge technologies like

“The skilled labour required for this industry is easily available in India. Also, Indian prices are very competitive compared to developed countries.—B.M. Shah, proprietor, Edkits Solution

embedded systems, instrumentation, process control, remote data-acquisition, mechatronics, advanced communication, VLSI and DSP are in great demand. Also, there is a steady demand for conventional technologies.

Joshi says, “These demands are market-driven, as the industry is looking for workforce trained in one of the above technologies to cut short their in-house training requirements.” “Tectonic shift in the technology domain is also an important factor. Educational institutes have to always keep themselves abreast of the latest trends and innovations. This creates a market for educational kits,” he adds.

Venkat points out, “Virtually, every electronic product developed today is an embedded system and may contain microprocessors, microcontrollers, DSPs, RAM, Flash, EEPROMs, FPGAs, ADCs, DACs, serial and parallel buses, embedded audio and switch-mode power supplies. Students need to be trained on the test equipment and procedures that are used to design and troubleshoot these multicomponent embedded systems.”

Raut says, “The new trends in trainer kits are advanced levels of wire-

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